Experiment 2

Zoho Creator Account Setup and Platform Exploration

1. Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create the Gym Membership Management application, and explore the main components of the Zoho Creator low-code platform that will be used in the later experiments.

2. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code platform for building custom business applications. Applications are created in a browser-based builder, stored and hosted by Zoho, and can be accessed from the web and mobile apps. Logic that cannot be set up visually is written in **Deluge**, Zoho's scripting language.

An application in Zoho Creator is made of forms (data capture), reports (data display), pages (dashboards and custom layouts), workflows (automation) and settings (users, permissions, connections). This experiment prepares the workspace in which the Gym Membership Management application will be built.

3. Procedure

- **Sign up.** Open the Zoho Creator website and choose the free trial, or sign in with an existing Zoho account. Complete email verification. The site may redirect to a regional domain.
- **Open the home dashboard.** After login, note the left-hand menu (applications, marketplace, templates and settings).
- **Create the application.** Choose Create Application, then Create from scratch. Enter the name *Gym Membership Management* and a short description. The application opens in the builder in development mode.
- **Explore the builder.** Open the Forms, Reports, Pages, Workflows and Settings areas and note the purpose of each.
- **Inspect the Deluge editor.** In a form's workflow, choose the On Success trigger and view the script editor and the drag-and-drop task list.
- **Check settings.** View the Users and Permissions, Connections and access-mode options, which are used in later experiments.
- **Clean up.** Remove any temporary test form so the application starts empty for the form-design experiments.

4. Platform Components

Component	Purpose	Use in the Gym application
Forms	Capture and store data; each form is a table	Member, Membership_Plan, Trainer, Subscription, Payment, Attendance
Reports	Display, search, filter and edit stored records	Active members list, expiring subscriptions, payments by month
Pages	Custom layouts and dashboards with charts and widgets	Command-center dashboard for the gym manager

Component	Purpose	Use in the Gym application
Workflows	Automation triggered by form events, schedules or approvals	End-date calculation, welcome email, expiry reminders
Deluge	Scripting language for custom logic and integrations	Date calculation, fetching records, sending email
Settings	Users, roles, connections, access and environments	Admin, receptionist, trainer and member roles
Marketplace and templates	Ready-made apps and extensions	Reference for design ideas

5. Application Created

Item	Value
Platform	Zoho Creator
Application name	Gym Membership Management
Description	Manage members, plans, subscriptions, payments and attendance
Initial mode	Development
Planned forms	Member, Membership_Plan, Trainer, Subscription, Payment, Attendance, Workout_Plan

6. Discussion

Starting from a blank application keeps the data model under the developer's control, whereas templates are faster but carry fields and workflows that may not fit the gym domain. The builder places forms, reports, pages and workflows in one workspace, so a single developer can move from data design to automation without switching tools.

Development mode separates work in progress from what end users see, which is important for the later experiments on roles, deployment and governance. Deluge is introduced here only as an editor to inspect; the first working scripts are written in the workflow experiment.

7. Result

The Zoho Creator workspace and the Gym Membership Management application were defined, and the main platform components were identified together with their roles in the project. The application is ready for form design in Experiment 4.

Evidence boundary: this record documents the setup procedure and platform exploration from the official documentation. Screenshots of the live account are not included.

8. References

- Zoho Creator: https://www.zoho.com/creator/

- Zoho Creator help: https://www.zoho.com/creator/help/
- Deluge scripting guide: https://www.zoho.com/deluge/help/